

SOKOLINK

A multi-seller marketplace where a customer buys from local shops and then chooses how the order reaches them — collected from a counter, or carried to their door. This report explains how the system works, screen by screen, and what each person can and cannot do.

DOCUMENT	How the system works, with screenshots
BUILD	Phases 0–3 complete; Phase 4 stages 4a–4d complete, 4e pending
STACK	PHP 8.2, MySQL / MariaDB, PDO. No framework.
TESTS	779 assertions across 14 suites, all passing
GENERATED	24 September 2026

CONTENTS

1	What the system is for	The problem it solves
2	The six kinds of user	Roles and what each may do
3	Test accounts and passwords	Every seeded login
4	How a request is handled	Architecture in one page
5	The customer's path	Browse, basket, checkout, track
6	The seller's path	List, stock, accept, prepare, hand over
7	The delivery agent's path	Offer, carry, hand over against a code
8	The support desk	Tickets, lookups, and what is recorded
9	Retention: messages and reorder	Consent, preferences, buying again
10	The administrator	Approvals and oversight
11	Money and payment	What can mark an order paid
12	Rules the system enforces	Access, codes, audit

1 WHAT THE SYSTEM IS FOR

SokoLink is a marketplace, not a shop. Many independent sellers list their own products; a customer fills one basket across several of them and pays once. What happens next is the part most marketplaces get wrong, and it is the part this system is built around.

One basket can become several orders. If a customer buys rice from one shop and soap from another, that is one payment but two pieces of work, in two different shops, that finish at different times. The system models this explicitly: the `order` holds the customer and the money; a `seller_order` holds each seller's part and has its own status. A customer's order list shows the parts, not the parent, because one row with one status would have to lie about one of them.

Every order ends in a handover, and a handover needs proof. Whether the customer collects at a counter or an agent brings it to the door, the order is only complete when a six-character code the customer holds is read back and matched. The code is stored as a SHA-256 hash and exists in plain text only in the message that was sent. Nobody can read it back — not the seller, not support, not an administrator.

THE TWO WAYS AN ORDER CAN REACH SOMEONE

ROUTE	WHO DOES THE WORK	HOW IT COMPLETES
Click and collect	The seller packs it and marks it ready at a named store	The customer comes in and reads out their collection code; the seller verifies it at the counter
Home delivery	The seller packs it; a delivery agent claims the job and carries it	The recipient reads out their code at the door; the agent enters it to complete

What is real and what is not. Accounts, baskets, orders, stock, deliveries, support tickets and notifications are real and are stored. No payment provider is connected: a card or mobile-money payment is settled by a clearly labelled sandbox driver and nothing is charged. Cash is real, and is recorded at the moment it changes hands. The administrator dashboard is the only area still showing sample data, and every one of its pages says so.

2 THE SIX KINDS OF USER

A role decides which area of the site somebody may reach. It does *not* by itself decide which rows they may see — that is a separate check, and section 12 explains why the difference matters.

ROLE	SIGNS IN AT	WHAT THEY DO	WHAT THEY MAY NEVER DO
Customer	/customer	Browse, fill a basket, check out, follow their orders, open a support request, manage messages, reorder	See another customer's order or ticket — the reference 404s exactly as an invented one does
Seller	/seller	List products, hold stock per store, accept and prepare orders, mark ready, verify a collection at the counter	See another seller's orders or products; trade at all before an administrator approves them
Delivery agent	/delivery	See offered jobs, claim one, collect from the store, deliver against the recipient's code, or record why they could not	See the recipient's name, address or phone for a job they have <i>not</i> accepted — the query does not select them
Support	/support	Work the ticket queue, reply, add internal notes, escalate, look up any order, reissue a collection code	Read a collection code; open an order without stating which ticket it was for
Administrator	/admin	Approve sellers, moderate, monitor deliveries and payments, settings, reports	— (this area is still on sample data pending stage 4e)
Guest	—	Browse the catalogue, search, fill a basket, read about the service	Check out, or open a support request — both need an account so the reply has somewhere to go

3 TEST ACCOUNTS AND PASSWORDS

These are development seed accounts. They exist only in the seeded `sokolink` database and are published in `database/seed.sql`. The password below is a development value, not a secret. If any of this is ever put in front of real people, every one of these accounts must be removed and the seed must not be loaded.

PASSWORD `SokoLink!Dev2026` — the same for every account listed below

SIGN IN AT `/login` — one form for every role; you land on the dashboard for yours

EVERY SEEDED ACCOUNT

#	EMAIL	ROLE	NAME	STATUS	WHAT IT IS FOR
1	admin@sokolink.test	Administrator	Platform Admin	active	The only account that can approve a seller
2	seller.mama.lishe@sokolink.test	Seller	Rehema Mushi	active	Mama Lishe Provisions — the busiest seller, has orders waiting
3	seller.duka.kuu@sokolink.test	Seller	Hassan Mrisho	active	Duka Kuu Wholesalers — a second seller, for split-order cases
4	seller.bustani@sokolink.test	Seller	Anna Mapunda	active	Bustani Fresh — fresh produce
5	seller.pending@sokolink.test	Seller	Hamisi Sokoni	pending_approval	Shows what an unapproved seller sees: the dashboard, but no ability to trade
6	agent.juma@sokolink.test	Delivery agent	Juma Kileo	active	Has assigned deliveries
7	agent.neema@sokolink.test	Delivery agent	Neema Bakari	active	A second agent, for testing that one agent cannot see another's jobs
8	support@sokolink.test	Support	Neema Support	active	The support desk
9	customer.asha@sokolink.test	Customer	Asha Mwinyi	active	The richest customer account: orders, history, tickets, reorder list
10	customer.baraka@sokolink.test	Customer	Baraka Joseph	active	Has an order awaiting a seller

11	customer.neema@sokolink.test	Customer	Neema Kessy	active	A second customer, for isolation testing
12	customer.grace@sokolink.test	Customer	Grace Temu	active	A third customer
13	customer.joseph@sokolink.test	Customer	Joseph Shirima	active	A fourth customer
14	customer.rashid@sokolink.test	Customer	Rashid Omary	suspended	Shows that a suspended account is signed out on its very next request, not at next login

WHICH ACCOUNT TO USE FOR WHAT

TO SEE...	SIGN IN AS
A full customer account with history	customer.asha@sokolink.test
Orders waiting to be accepted and packed	seller.mama.lishe@sokolink.test
A seller who cannot trade yet	seller.pending@sokolink.test
Deliveries to carry	agent.juma@sokolink.test
The ticket queue	support@sokolink.test
Seller approvals and platform figures	admin@sokolink.test

4 HOW A REQUEST IS HANDLED

Every request follows the same path, and two rules are enforced by where the code lives rather than by anyone remembering them.

LAYER	RESPONSIBILITY	RULE
<code>public/index.php</code>	The single entry point	Nothing above this folder is reachable over HTTP, so source, <code>.env</code> , SQL and logs cannot be downloaded
Router + middleware	Route matching, <code>auth</code> , <code>role:</code> , <code>verified</code> , throttling, CSRF	CSRF is applied to every POST by the router itself, not listed per route
Controller	Read input, call a service, choose a view	Never writes SQL
Service	The business rules, and the only place a decision is made	Refuses invalid work regardless of what the page allowed
Repository	The only layer that writes SQL	"Can anything read another seller's orders?" is answerable by reading one folder
Presenter → View	Shapes rows into what a page shows	A view never touches a repository

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU SUBMIT A FORM

- 1 The router checks the CSRF token. Without a valid one the request is a 403, whatever else it contains.
- 2 The controller hands the input to a service inside a common wrapper.
- 3 If you typed something wrong, you get **per-field messages beside each field** and the form keeps what you typed.
- 4 If the action is not allowed, you get **one clear sentence** saying why.
- 5 If it worked, the browser is **redirected** (303) — so refreshing the confirmation page re-displays it instead of ordering again.
- 6 Anything unexpected is logged with a reference number and shown as a generic error, never as a stack trace.

Placing an order is idempotent. The checkout page mints a key held in your session. A double-clicked button, a refreshed POST and a browser retry all replay the same key, and the service returns the order it already made rather than making a second one.

5 THE CUSTOMER'S PATH

Everything up to the basket works signed out. An account is required only at checkout, because an order needs somewhere to send a collection code.

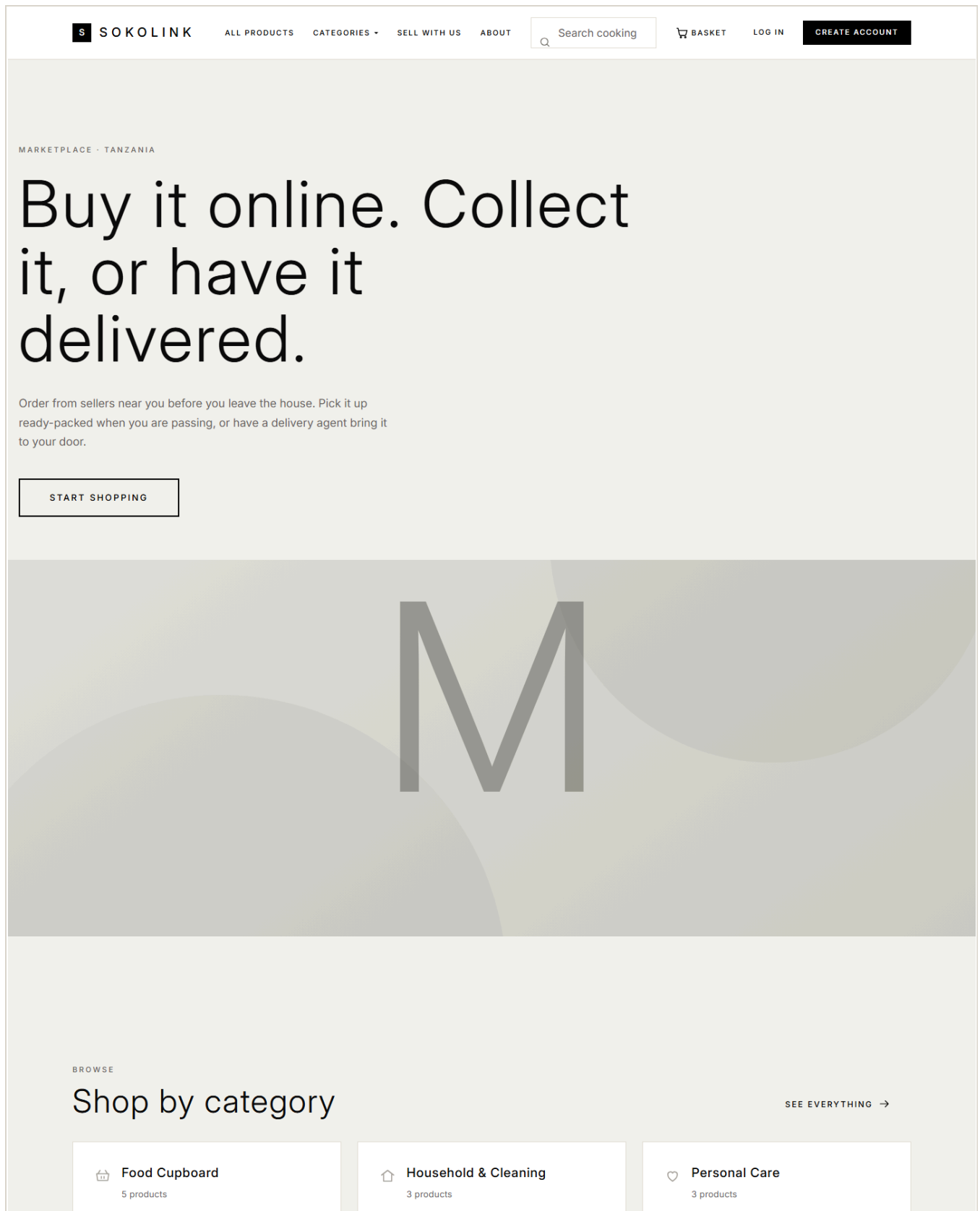


Figure 1 — Home. The two ways an order can reach somebody are stated before anything is sold, because that choice changes what the customer pays and how long it takes. Categories and the basket count in the header are read from the database on every page.

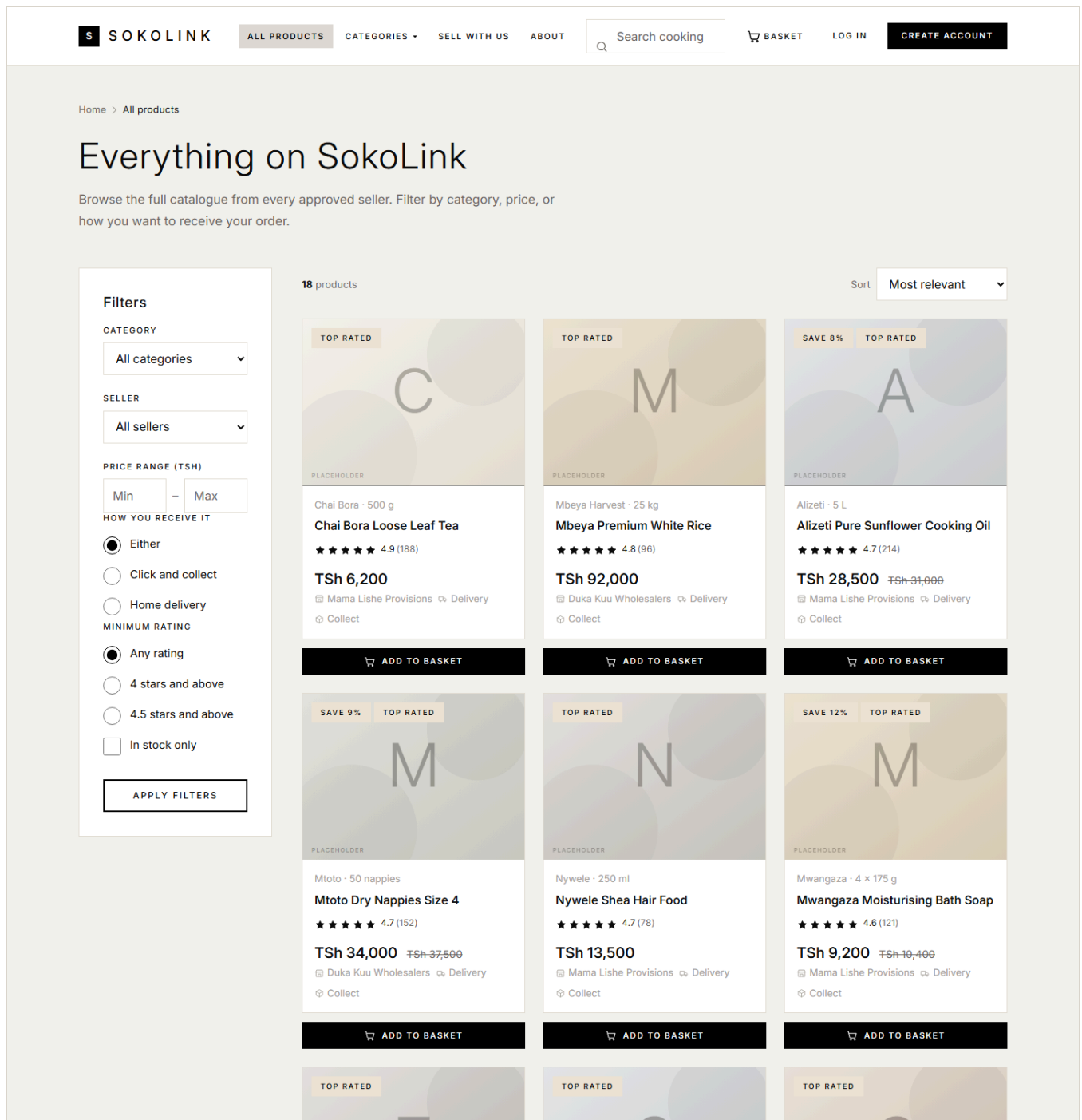


Figure 2 — Catalogue. Filters are a real GET form: the URL carries the filter state, so a filtered list can be bookmarked, shared and used with the back button. Stock is summed per store, so “in stock” means a specific counter can supply it. Where a seller has not uploaded a photograph, a neutral panel marked PLACEHOLDER stands in, so a catalogue of them can never be mistaken for finished photography.

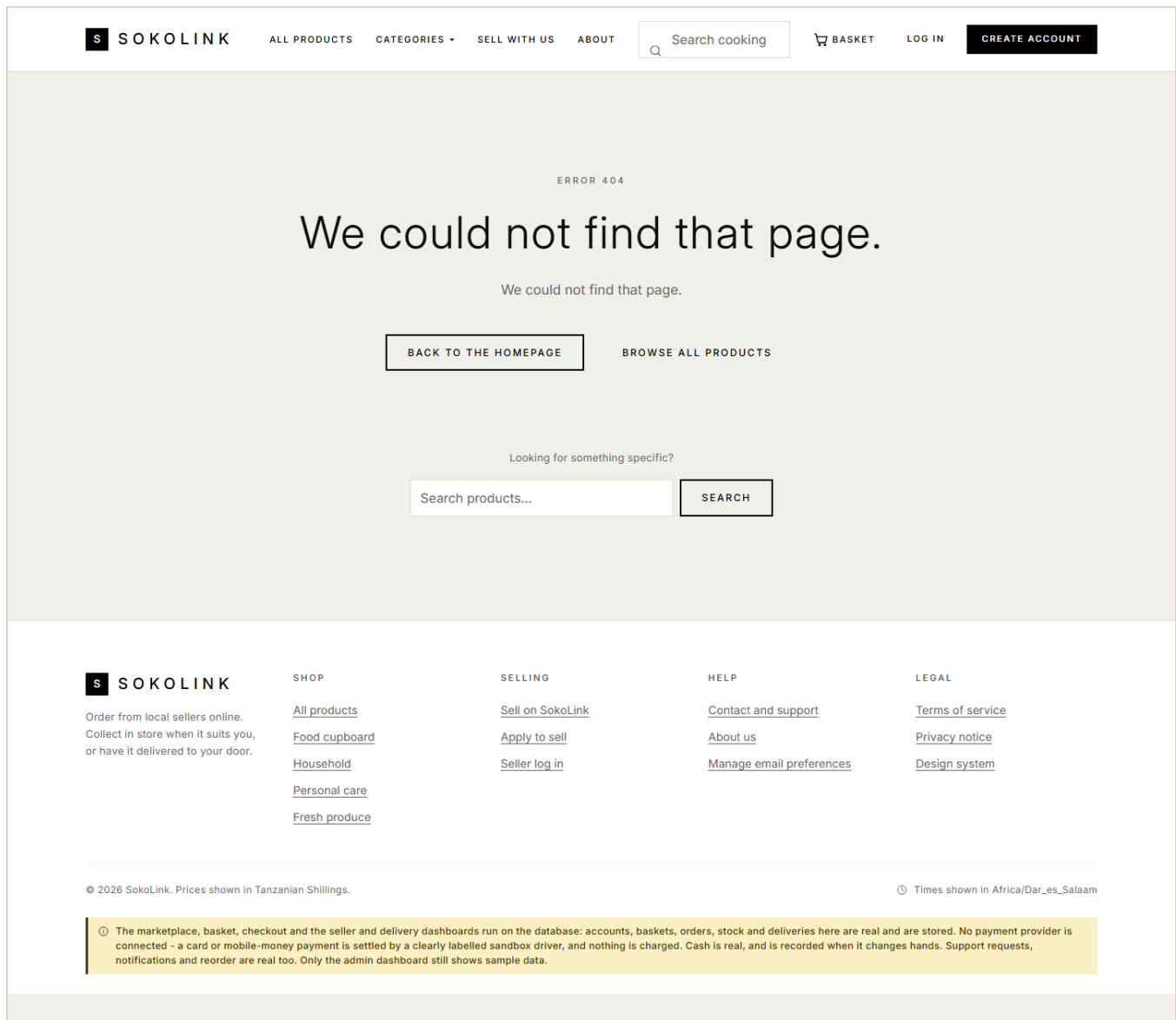


Figure 3 — A product. Availability is shown *per store* rather than as one global number, because the customer has to choose where to collect from. Adding to the basket records which store will supply that line; checkout refuses a line without one.

WHAT HAPPENS BETWEEN THE BASKET AND A CONFIRMED ORDER

- 1 The basket** groups lines by seller, because each group becomes its own order part with its own delivery fee and its own status.
- 2 Fulfilment** — collect or deliver — is chosen per seller group, since one shop may not offer both.
- 3 Every amount is recalculated on the server** from database prices at the moment of checkout. Nothing the browser sends about a price is trusted.
- 4 Stock is reserved**, not deducted. A reservation is not a sale; the shelf count only changes at handover.
- 5 Payment.** Cash on fulfilment goes straight to the seller with nothing to collect up front. A card or mobile-money payment is settled by the sandbox driver, which signs a real payload and posts it to the real webhook handler.

6 **The order splits** into one part per seller, each with its own reference, and the customer is told what happens next for each.

S

SOKOLINK

CUSTOMER

ORDERS

Overview

Active orders

2

Order history

Reorder

Payments

ACCOUNT

Profile

Addresses

MESSAGES

Notifications

3

Email preferences

HELP

My reviews

Support

1

Back to marketplace

Log out

My account

ASHA MWINYI

Hello, Asha

Everything you have on the go, and the things you buy often.

ACTIVE ORDERS

2

Being prepared or on the way

UNREAD MESSAGES

0

Order updates and reminders

COMPLETED ORDERS

2

All time

LIFETIME SPEND

TSh 74.8K

Across all sellers

WHAT IS HAPPENING NOW

SL-2026-9F3K2A · Mama Lishe Provisions

READY TO COLLECT

Collect from Mama Lishe - Kariakoo

Ready to collect. Your collection code was emailed to you - only its hash is stored, so we cannot show it here. Bring it to Mama Lishe - Kariakoo.

2 items · TSh 40,900 · placed 4 days ago

TRACK THIS ORDER

SL-2026-9F3K2A · Duka Kuu Wholesalers

OUT FOR DELIVERY

Delivery to your address

1 item · TSh 40,000 · placed 4 days ago

TRACK THIS ORDER

Recent messages

See all

Order is out for delivery

An agent is on the way with your order. Have your delivery code ready.
2 days ago

A message from SokoLink

There is an update on your account. (No template is defined for "order.ready_for_pickup"....
3 days ago

Running low on something?

Hello there, You bought on . Based on your purchase history, you might be running low...
1 week ago

Reorder reminders

You have reminders switched on. We work out roughly when you will run low from how much you bought and how often you have reordered before - not from a fixed calendar.

CHANGE WHAT YOU RECEIVE

BUY AGAIN

Things you have bought before, with today's price and availability checked.

M

Mwangaza Moisturising Bath Soap

4 x 175 g · last bought 6 Aug 2026

TSh 9,200

REORDER

A

Alizeti Pure Sunflower Cooking Oil

5 L · last bought 6 Aug 2026

TSh 28,500

REORDER

M

Meno Safi Fluoride Toothpaste

150 ml · last bought 14 Jul 2026

TSh 4,600

REORDER

SEE EVERYTHING YOU CAN REORDER →

Figure 4 — Customer overview (signed in as Asha Mwinyi). Active orders, recent messages and a reorder panel. Lifetime spend is summed over completed *parts*, not parent orders, so a part that was refunded does not count money that came back.

S

SOKOLINK

CUSTOMER

ORDERS

Overview

Active orders2

Order history

Reorder

Payments

ACCOUNT

Profile

Addresses

MESSAGES

Notifications3

My account

AM

ASHA MWINYI

Active orders

ORDER HISTORY

Each seller in an order is prepared and tracked separately, so one order can appear here more than once.

ORDER	HOW	STATUS	PLACED	TOTAL	
SL-2026-9F3K2A Mama Lishe Provisions	Collect - Mama Lishe - Kariakoo	● READY TO COLLECT	4 days ago	TSh 40,900	TRACK
SL-2026-9F3K2A Duka Kuu Wholesalers	Delivery	● OUT FOR DELIVERY	4 days ago	TSh 40,000	TRACK

SokoLink · Customer view · times in Africa/Dar_es_Salaam · [Back to the marketplace](#)

Figure 5 — Orders. The list shows order *parts*. One basket split between two sellers appears as two rows, because one can be ready to collect while the other is still being packed, and a single row would have to misreport one of them.

6 THE SELLER’S PATH

A seller signs in to the same form as everyone else and lands on their own dashboard. Every query behind it is filtered by their seller id, so another seller’s order simply does not exist as far as the page is concerned.

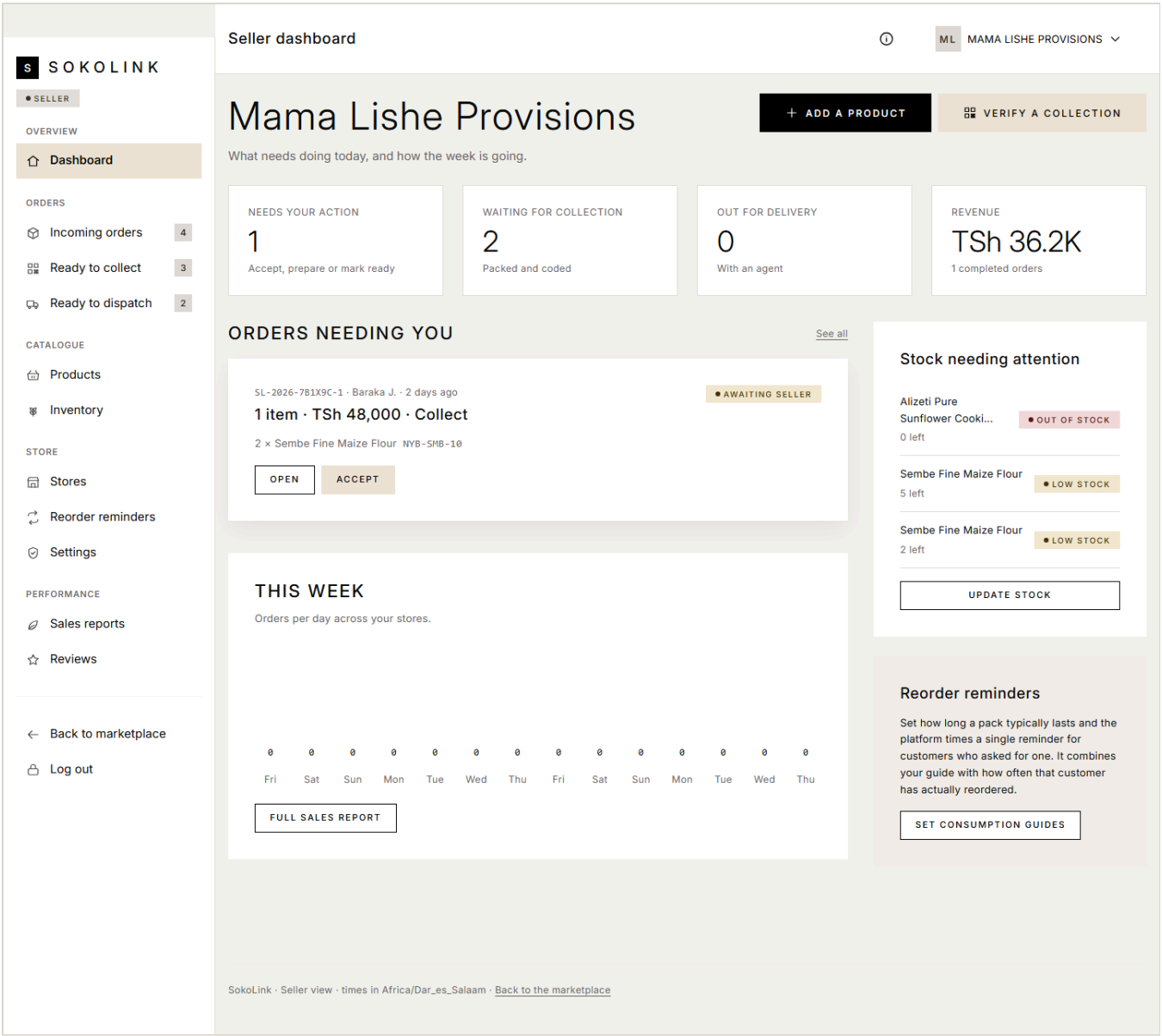


Figure 6 — Seller dashboard (Mama Lishe Provisions). The page opens on what needs doing rather than on figures: orders awaiting acceptance, parcels waiting to be collected, and stock about to run out. The counters in the sidebar are the same numbers, so the navigation itself says where the work is.

THE ORDER LIFECYCLE A SELLER DRIVES

STEP WHAT THE SELLER DOES WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES

1	Accepts the order	Moves it to confirmed and tells the customer
2	Starts preparing	Moves it to preparing

3	Marks it ready	Issues the collection code , hashes it, and sends the plain text to the customer. For a delivery it instead creates the job agents can claim
4	Verifies at the counter	Hashes what was typed and compares. A wrong code is counted; too many and it locks
5	—	On a match: stock leaves the shelf, cash is recorded if it was a cash order, and the part completes

The state machine refuses to be skipped. Marking an order ready before accepting it is not a disabled button — it is refused by the service with a sentence explaining why. The page shows the state rather than hiding the control, because a control that vanishes teaches nobody anything.

SOKOLINK

SELLER

OVERVIEW

Dashboard

ORDERS

Incoming orders 4

Ready to collect 3

Ready to dispatch 2

CATALOGUE

Products

Inventory

STORE

Stores

Reorder reminders

Settings

PERFORMANCE

Sales reports

Reviews

Back to marketplace

Log out

Seller dashboard

ML MAMA LISHE PROVISIONS

Products

Everything you have listed. Stock is held per store and managed separately.

LIVE 7

DRAFTS 0

IN STOCK 6

OUT OF STOCK 0

ALL

DRAFTS

LIVE

ARCHIVED

PRODUCT	SKU	CATEGORY	STATE	STOCK	AVAILABLE	PRICE		
Alizeti Pure Sunflower Cooking Oil	ALZ-OIL-5L	Cooking Oil & Fats	PUBLISHED	IN STOCK	26	TSh 28,500	EDIT	VIEW
Mwangaza Moisturising Bath Soap	MWG-BSP-4	Soap & Bath	PUBLISHED	IN STOCK	46	TSh 9,200	EDIT	VIEW
Safi Multi-Surface Cleaner	SAF-MSC-2L	Surface Cleaning	PUBLISHED	IN STOCK	30	TSh 9,800	EDIT	VIEW
Nywele Shea Hair Food	NYW-SHF-250	Hair Care	PUBLISHED	IN STOCK	12	TSh 13,500	EDIT	VIEW
Sembe Fine Maize Flour	NYB-SMB-10	Flour & Baking	PUBLISHED	LOW STOCK	7	TSh 24,000	EDIT	VIEW
Chemchem Drinking Water	CHM-WTR-12	Water	PUBLISHED	IN STOCK	93	TSh 13,200	EDIT	VIEW
Chai Bora Loose Leaf Tea	CHB-TEA-500	Tea & Coffee	PUBLISHED	IN STOCK	52	TSh 6,200	EDIT	VIEW

7 products in total. Publishing and archiving are on each product's own page, because both have conditions: a product needs stock somewhere before it can be published, and one with units already promised to orders cannot be archived out from under them.

SokoLink · Seller view · times in Africa/Dar_es_Salaam · [Back to the marketplace](#)

Figure 7 — Products. A product cannot be published without stock somewhere: publishing something nobody can supply produces an order that must then be cancelled. The rule lives in the service, so it holds however the product is edited.

S

SOKOLINK

• SELLER

OVERVIEW

Dashboard

ORDERS

Incoming orders 4

Ready to collect 3

Ready to dispatch 2

CATALOGUE

Products

Inventory

STORE

Stores

Reorder reminders

Settings

PERFORMANCE

Sales reports

Reviews

← Back to marketplace

Log out

Seller dashboard

ML MAMA LISHE PROVISIONS

Inventory

Stock is held per store. Adjustments need a reason and are recorded permanently.

Available = on hand – reserved. Reserved means already promised to an order that has been placed. You cannot set stock below what is reserved, because that would be un-selling something a customer has already paid for.

MAMA LISHE - KARIAKOO

ILALA, DAR ES SALAAM

PRODUCT	SKU	ON HAND	RESERVED	AVAILABLE	STATE	ADJUST
Alizeti Pure Sunflower Cooking Oil 5 L	ALZ-OIL-5L	1	1	0	OUT OF STOCK	1 Reason... CORRECT + qty RECEIVED
Chai Bora Loose Leaf Tea 500 g	CHB-TEA-500	54	2	52	IN STOCK	54 Reason... CORRECT + qty RECEIVED
Chemchem Drinking Water 12 x 1.5 L	CHM-WTR-12	60	2	58	IN STOCK	60 Reason... CORRECT + qty RECEIVED
Mwangaza Moisturising Bath Soap 4 x 175 g	MWG-BSP-4	30	0	30	IN STOCK	30 Reason... CORRECT + qty RECEIVED
Nywele Shea Hair Food 250 ml	NYW-SHF-250	12	0	12	IN STOCK	12 Reason... CORRECT + qty RECEIVED
						20 Reason...

Figure 8 — Inventory. Stock is held *per store*, not per product, because that is the question a customer is really asking: can this counter supply it? Every movement is written to an append-only ledger, so “where did twelve units go?” always has an answer.

7 THE DELIVERY AGENT'S PATH

S

SOKOLINK

DELIVERY AGENT

TODAY

Overview

My deliveries

3

Available jobs

2

RECORD

History

Back to marketplace

Log out

Deliveries

JK

JUMA KILEO

Today

Your assigned deliveries and any jobs you can pick up.

ASSIGNED TO YOU

1

Live deliveries

JOBS AVAILABLE

0

You can accept or decline

COMPLETED

1

All time

DELIVERY FEES

TSh 12K

On the jobs in view

AVAILABLE JOBS

CURRENT JOB

ASHA MWINYI

DEL-4412 - DSM North

Chole Road 22, Msasani, Kinondoni, Dar es Salaam

Blue gate opposite the pharmacy

From the customer: Call on arrival, the gate bell does not work.

OPEN THIS DELIVERY

CALL RECIPIENT

OUT FOR DELIVERY

YOUR DELIVERIES

Asha Mwinyi

DEL-4412 - DSM North

Chole Road 22, Msasani, Kinondoni, Dar es Salaam

OPEN

OUT FOR DELIVERY

What you can see

Only deliveries assigned to you, and only what you need to deliver them: the recipient, the address, the instructions and a masked phone number. Not what is in the parcel, not what the customer paid, and nothing about their other orders.

Recently completed

Asha Mwinyi

Delivered 2 months ago

FULL HISTORY

Figure 9 — Agent dashboard (Juma Kileo). Only this agent's own tasks. Another agent's task is a 404, is absent from this list, and is unchanged by posting its reference to a handler.

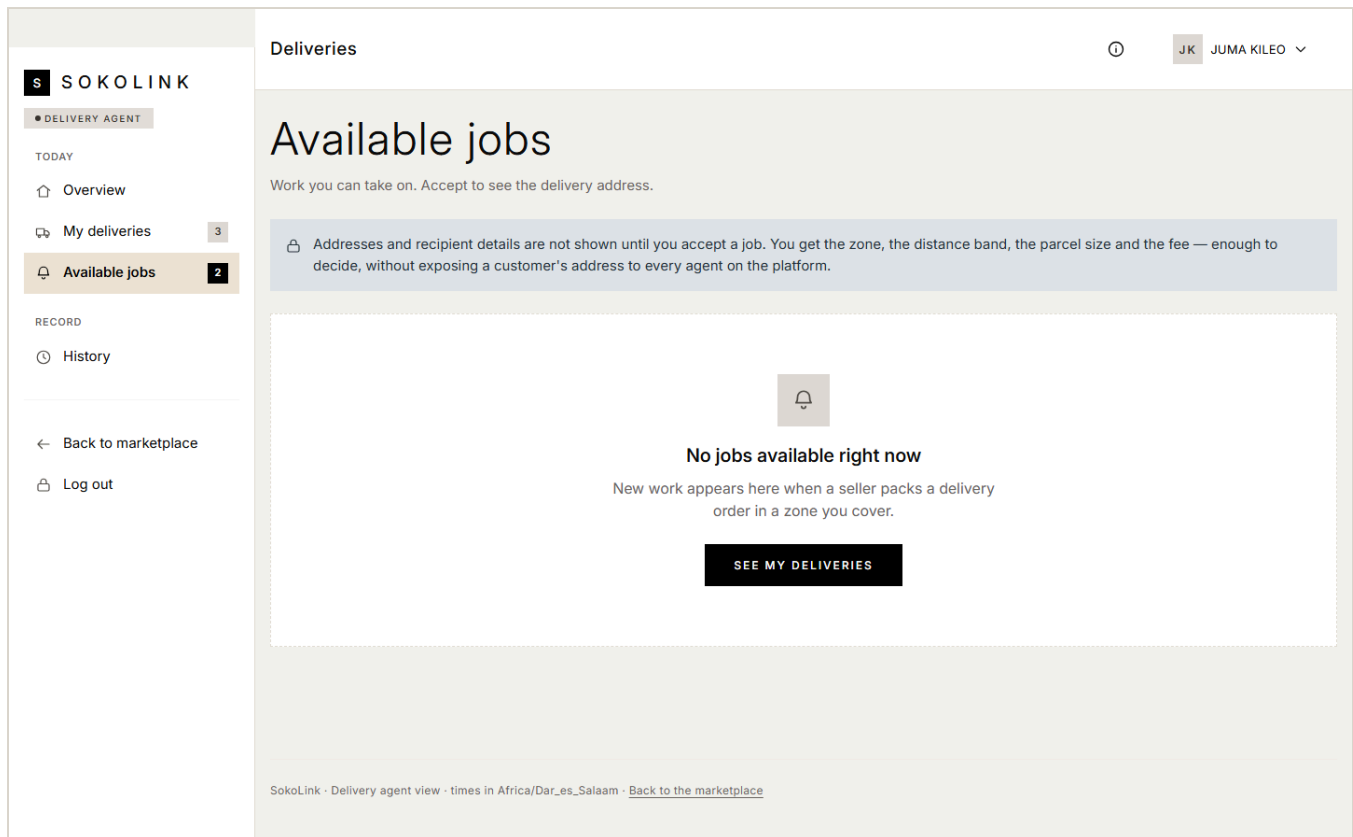


Figure 10 — Offers. The queue is empty here, and correctly so: the one unclaimed parcel in this data is still being packed, and a parcel that is not ready is not offered to anybody. The banner states the rule that governs this page — a job the agent has **not** accepted shows the zone, the collection point, the fee and a size band, and no name, no address, no phone number. Those columns are not hidden by the template; the query behind this page does not select them, so a future change to the page cannot leak one.

CARRYING A PARCEL

- 1 The agent claims an offer, or an administrator assigns one. Only now do the recipient's details appear.
- 2 They collect from the store and mark it picked up, then out for delivery. The order follows each step.
- 3 At the door the recipient reads out their six-character code. **It is the only thing that completes a delivery** — there is no "mark as delivered" button.
- 4 If nobody is there, the agent records a failure with a reason chosen from a fixed list, in their own words, and it is logged permanently.
- 5 After the allowed number of attempts the parcel goes back to the seller and the order moves to `refund_pending` — the money is owed.

Cash at the door is a real payment. When an agent hands over a cash order, a payment transaction is written at that moment. Before this was built, every figure resting on payment status was wrong by exactly the cash takings.

8 THE SUPPORT DESK

Support is the one area with **no ownership filter**, and that is deliberate: a desk that can only see some orders cannot answer the phone. The control is therefore not a `WHERE` clause but a trail.

The screenshot shows the 'Support desk' interface for 'SOKOLINK'. The left sidebar contains navigation links: 'SUPPORT', 'DESK' (with 'Overview' selected), 'Ticket queue' (5), 'LOOKUPS' (with 'Order lookup' and 'Notification monitor'), and 'ESCALATION' (with 'Escalated' (2)). The main content area is titled 'Support overview' and includes a 'TICKET QUEUE' button. It displays four summary cards: 'OPEN TICKETS' (1, 'Not yet picked up or in progress'), 'UNASSIGNED' (1, 'Nobody has picked these up'), 'HIGH PRIORITY' (1, 'Order or delivery problems'), and 'ESCALATED' (1, 'With an administrator'). Below these is a 'NEEDS ATTENTION' section showing a ticket for 'TKT-2026-9412 · Baraka Joseph · order SL-2026-781X9C' with the title 'Collection code not working'. The ticket description states: 'I am at the Mbezi Beach store and the counter says my code is not recognised. The order still shows as awaiting seller in my accou...'. It has 'HIGH PRIORITY' and 'OPEN' status tags, and buttons for 'OPEN' and 'ASSIGN TO ME'. It was 'Opened 2 days ago'. To the right, a 'Messages not getting through' section explains that customers may not know what is happening with their order, which is usually the cause of the next ticket. It shows a failed delivery attempt for 'Grace Temu' (3 attempts) and a 'NOTIFICATION MONITOR' button. Below this is a 'What you can see' section explaining that users can open customer records but cannot see sensitive information like password hashes or payment credentials. At the bottom right, a 'Quick lookups' section provides buttons for 'FIND AN ORDER', 'NOTIFICATION MONITOR', and 'ESCALATED TICKETS'. The footer shows 'SokoLink · Support view · times in Africa/Dar_es_Salaam · [Back to the marketplace](#)'.

Figure 11 — Support overview. What is waiting, what is urgent, and whether messages are actually reaching customers — a message that failed to send is usually the cause of the next ticket.

S

SOKOLINK

SUPPORT

DESK

Overview

Ticket queue

5

LOOKUPS

Order lookup

Notification monitor

ESCALATION

Escalated

2

Back to marketplace

Log out

Support desk

NEEMA SUPPORT

Ticket queue

Everything customers have raised, and who has it.

Open

1

Escalated

1

Waiting on customer

1

Resolved

1

Everything

5

REFERENCE	SUBJECT	CUSTOMER	PRIORITY	STATUS	ASSIGNED	UPDATED	
TKT-2026-0412	Collection code not working SL-2026-7B1X9C	Baraka Joseph	High	OPEN	Unassigned	2 days ago	OPEN

SokoLink · Support view · times in Africa/Dar_es_Salaam · [Back to the marketplace](#)

Figure 12 — Ticket queue. An agent takes a ticket, replies, or adds an internal note. A reply the customer can read moves the ticket to “waiting on customer”; an internal note does not, because the customer never sees it and so is not waiting on anything.

INTERNAL NOTES: THE FILTER IS IN THE QUERY

A support thread has two audiences and they see different rows. The customer’s query carries `is_internal = 0` in its `WHERE` clause, so those rows are never fetched for their page. A template-level hide would be one careless change — one export feature, one JSON endpoint — away from showing a customer what staff wrote about them. The automated test asserts this against the returned rows rather than the rendered page, so a template that merely happened to hide a note would still fail.

S

SOKOLINK

• SUPPORT

DESK

Overview

Ticket queue

5

LOOKUPS

Order lookup

Notification monitor

ESCALATION

Escalated

2

← Back to marketplace

Log out

Support desk

NS NEEMA SUPPORT

Order lookup

Find an order by reference or customer name to answer a question about it.

ORDER REFERENCE OR CUSTOMER

SL-2026-... or a name

WHICH TICKET IS THIS FOR?

TKT-2026-... or a short reason

Recorded against every order you open.

SEARCH

Every order you open is logged.

The audit entry records who you are, which order, when, and why. Fill in the ticket above and the results below will carry it for you. Without one you will be asked again before anything opens.

Nothing matched

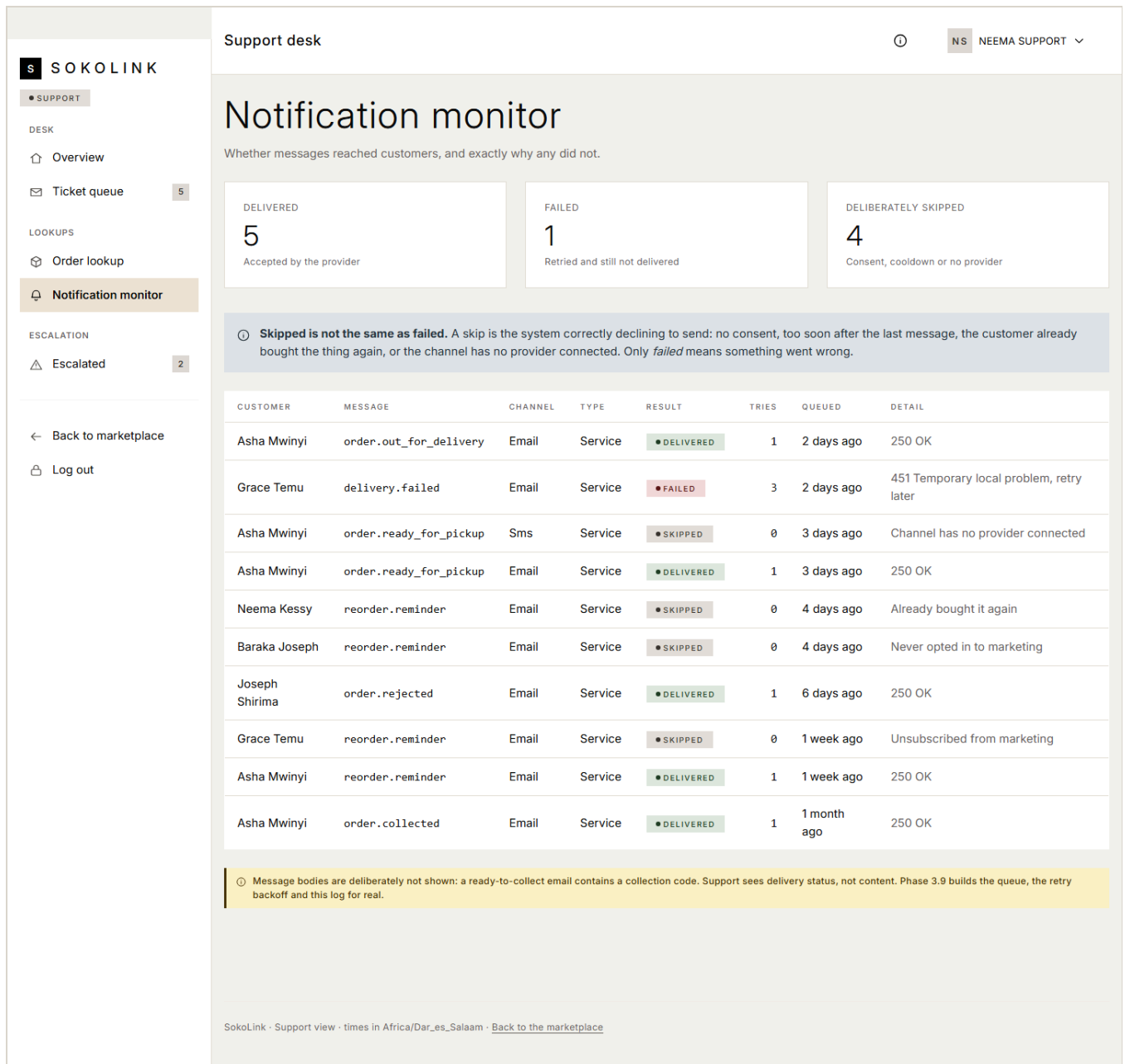
Check the reference, or search by the customer name instead.

CLEAR THE SEARCH

SokoLink · Support view · times in Africa/Dar_es_Salaam · [Back to the marketplace](#)

Figure 13 — Order lookup. The reason is asked for *beside the search*, not after the agent has already seen the result, and it is carried into every result link. Opening an order writes an audit row naming the agent, the order, the time and the ticket that justified it — including a lookup that found nothing, so “it errored” is not a way to look at a record unseen.

Support can cause a new collection code to be sent and cannot read one. The customer rang because the message never arrived; making them ring the shop instead is not support. The new code goes to the customer’s own channel, the old one stops working immediately, and the agent never sees either. An agent who could read a collection code could collect somebody’s order.



9 RETENTION: MESSAGES AND REORDER

SOKOLINK

CUSTOMER

ORDERS

Overview

Active orders2

Order history

Reorder

Payments

ACCOUNT

Profile

Addresses

MESSAGES

Notifications3

Email preferences

HELP

My reviews

Support1

Back to marketplace

Log out

My account

Support

Requests you have opened and where each one has got to.

REFERENCE	SUBJECT	STATUS	LAST UPDATE
TKT-2026-0402	Wrong pack size delivered SL-2026-1A5B3C	● WAITING ON CUSTOMER	1 week ago

OPEN A REQUEST

We reply by email and on this page. If it is about an order, attaching the reference saves us asking for it.

WHAT IS IT ABOUT? *

One line - "Collection code never arrived"

TOPIC *

A problem with an order

WHICH ORDER?

Not about a specific order

Only your own orders are listed, and only your own are accepted.

WHAT HAPPENED? *

Please do not include passwords, PINs or full card numbers. Support staff cannot see them and will never ask.

OPEN THE REQUEST

Before you open a request

- Your collection code is on the order page and in the ready-to-collect email.
- The order page shows the live delivery status and the reason for any failed attempt.
- To stop reminder emails, use [email preferences](#) — no request needed.

SokoLink · Customer view · times in Africa/Dar_es_Salaam · [Back to the marketplace](#)

Figure 15 — The customer's own requests. Opening one attaches an order reference only if that order is *theirs*; another customer's reference is refused with a message. Replying to a resolved request reopens it.

S

SOKOLINK

CUSTOMER

ORDERS

Overview

Active orders2

Order history

Reorder

Payments

ACCOUNT

Profile

Addresses

MESSAGES

Notifications3

Email preferences

HELP

My reviews

Support1

Back to marketplace

Log out

My account

1

AMASHA MWINYI

Email preferences

What we send you, and how. You can change any of this at any time.

CHANNELS

Email is the only channel connected. The others are built as interfaces so a provider can be added without touching anything else — but nothing is connected, so they are not offered as choices that would silently do nothing.

☒Email

Connected. Sent to customer.asha@sokolink.test. Development mode: messages are written to storage/logs/mail.log instead of being sent.

CONNECTED

☐SMS

No SMS provider is connected. Messages queued for SMS are recorded as skipped.

NOT CONNECTED

☐WhatsApp

No WhatsApp Business account is connected.

NOT CONNECTED

WHAT WE SEND

Messages about an order you placed are part of the service you bought, so they are always sent while that order is open. Everything marked optional is yours to switch off.

☒Order updates

ALWAYS SENT

Confirmed, accepted, being prepared, ready, delivered, refunded.

Switching this off would mean not being told your order is waiting for you, so it is not offered.

☒Collection and delivery alerts

ALWAYS SENT

Your collection code, and when an agent is on the way.

Switching this off would mean not being told your order is waiting for you, so it is not offered.

☒Support replies

ALWAYS SENT

Replies to a support request you opened.

Switching this off would mean not being told your order is waiting for you, so it is not offered.

☒Reorder reminders

OPTIONAL

An occasional nudge when something you buy regularly is probably running low.

☒Offers and promotions

OPTIONAL

Reduced prices and seasonal offers.

QUIET HOURS

Optional messages are held from 21:00 until 07:00 and go out the following morning instead of at 2am. Order updates ignore this, because a failed delivery cannot wait until breakfast.

This window applies to everyone and is not yours to set — so it is shown here as what it is, rather than as two dropdowns that would save nothing.

SAVE PREFERENCES

Your consent record

Marketing consentGIVEN

Given on14 Mar 2026, 22:12

Recorded atRegistration

Versionv1.0

Every change is recorded with who, when and from where, so we can show what you agreed to and when.

Stop everything optional

One click, takes effect immediately, and cancels anything already queued but not yet sent. The same link is at the bottom of every marketing email and works without logging in.

UNSUBSCRIBE FROM MARKETING

Figure 16 — Preferences and consent. Which categories are optional is a rule decided in the service, not a flag in the page. Messages about an order the customer placed are part of what they bought and are not offered as a toggle — and a crafted request asking to switch them off is ignored rather than obeyed. Switching every optional category off withdraws marketing consent, so the record can never contradict the settings. SMS and WhatsApp are shown as *not connected* rather than as switches that would silently do nothing.

Unsubscribe means now. It also cancels marketing already queued but not yet sent. Otherwise “takes effect immediately” is true only from the batch after the one already on its way.

S

SOKOLINK

CUSTOMER

ORDERS

Overview

Active orders2

Order history

Reorder

Payments

ACCOUNT

Profile

Addresses

MESSAGES

Notifications3

Email preferences

HELP

My reviews

Support1

Back to marketplace

Log out

My account

AM

ASHA MWINYI

Reorder

BASKET (4 CAN BE ADDED)

Things you have bought before. We have re-checked today's price and stock for each one.

Prices and availability below were checked just now against the seller's current listing, not against what you paid last time. Anything that changed is flagged, and nothing is added to your basket until you confirm.

A

Alizeti Pure Sunflower Cooking Oil

5 L · Mama Lishe Provisions · last bought 6 Aug 2026

AVAILABLE AT THE SAME PRICE

TSh 28,500

ADD 1

M

Mwangaza Moisturising Bath Soap

4 x 175 g · Mama Lishe Provisions · last bought 6 Aug 2026

AVAILABLE AT THE SAME PRICE

TSh 9,200

ADD 1

K

Kilombero Brown Sugar

2 kg · Duka Kuu Wholesalers · last bought 14 Jul 2026

AVAILABLE AT THE SAME PRICE

TSh 7,800

ADD 3

M

Meno Safi Fluoride Toothpaste

150 ml · Duka Kuu Wholesalers · last bought 14 Jul 2026

AVAILABLE AT THE SAME PRICE

TSh 4,600

ADD 2

How we decide when to remind you

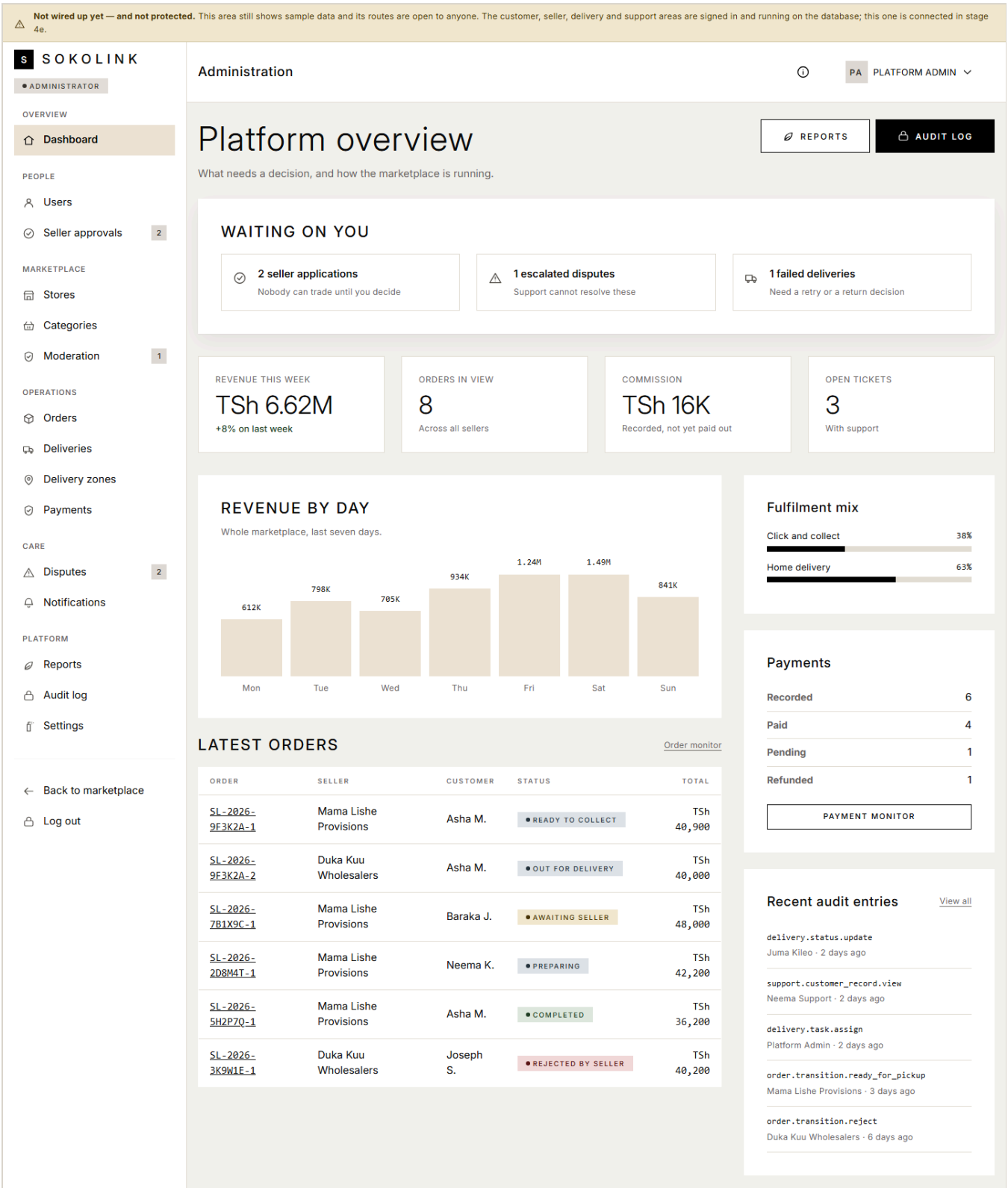
We do not assume you have run out just because a set number of days has passed. The estimate uses, in order of preference: how often you have actually reordered this product, then the seller's guide for how long a pack lasts scaled by how much you bought. If neither exists, we send nothing rather than guessing.

MANAGE REMINDERS

SokoLink · Customer view · times in Africa/Dar_es_Salaam · Back to the marketplace

Figure 17 — Reorder. Every line is re-priced and re-checked before it is offered. The quantity shown is what pressing Add would *actually* put in the basket — the best single store's stock, minus what the basket already holds. A price that moved is flagged with both figures rather than absorbed. Nothing is ever substituted: if a seller has stopped listing something, the answer is “we cannot get you this”, not a different product with a similar name.

10 THE ADMINISTRATOR



PLATFORM

Reports

Audit log

Settings

Back to marketplace

Log out

Administration

Platform overview

What needs a decision, and how the marketplace is running.

WAITING ON YOU

2 seller applications
Nobody can trade until you decide

1 escalated disputes
Support cannot resolve these

1 failed deliveries
Need a retry or a return decision

REVENUE THIS WEEK
TSh 6.62M
+8% on last week

ORDERS IN VIEW
8
Across all sellers

COMMISSION
TSh 16K
Recorded, not yet paid out

OPEN TICKETS
3
With support

REVENUE BY DAY

Whole marketplace, last seven days.

612K

798K

705K

934K

1.24M

1.49M

841K

MonTueWedThuFriSatSun

Fulfilment mix

Click and collect38%

Home delivery63%

Payments

Recorded6

Paid4

Pending1

Refunded1

PAYMENT MONITOR

LATEST ORDERS

Order monitor

ORDER	SELLER	CUSTOMER	STATUS	TOTAL
SL-2026-9F3K2A-1	Mama Lishe Provisions	Asha M.	READY TO COLLECT	TSh 40,900
SL-2026-9F3K2A-2	Duka Kuu Wholesalers	Asha M.	OUT FOR DELIVERY	TSh 40,000
SL-2026-7B1X9C-1	Mama Lishe Provisions	Baraka J.	AWAITING SELLER	TSh 48,000
SL-2026-2D8M4T-1	Mama Lishe Provisions	Neema K.	PREPARING	TSh 42,200
SL-2026-5H2P7Q-1	Mama Lishe Provisions	Asha M.	COMPLETED	TSh 36,200
SL-2026-3K9W1E-1	Duka Kuu Wholesalers	Joseph S.	REJECTED BY SELLER	TSh 40,200

Recent audit entries

View all

delivery.status.update
Juma Kileo · 2 days ago

support.customer_record.view
Neema Support · 2 days ago

delivery.task.assign
Platform Admin · 2 days ago

order.transition.ready_for_pickup
Mama Lishe Provisions · 3 days ago

order.transition.reject
Duka Kuu Wholesalers · 6 days ago

Figure 18 — Platform overview. The page opens on decisions waiting on a person — seller applications, escalated disputes, failed deliveries — before any figures, because those are the only things that stop while nobody acts.

This area is not wired yet. It renders sample data behind routes that are still open, and a banner on every one of

its pages says so. It is the work of stage 4e. Everything else in this report runs on the database.

THE ONE THING ONLY AN ADMINISTRATOR CAN DO

A seller can register, sign in, see their dashboard and start building a catalogue while their application is pending — somebody waiting on a decision should be able to prepare. What they cannot do is **trade**. No route gate can express that distinction, so every service that matters checks `sellers.status = 'active'` directly. Sign in as `seller.pending@sokolink.test` to see it.

11 MONEY AND PAYMENT

No payment provider is connected and nothing is ever charged. A card or mobile-money payment is settled by a sandbox driver that signs a real payload and posts it to the real webhook handler, so the code that will face a live provider is the code being exercised now.

WHAT CAN MARK AN ORDER PAID

PATH	WHEN	GUARD
Signed webhook	The gateway confirms	The signature must verify. One that does not is recorded and ignored
Cash at the counter	The seller verifies the collection code	One transaction per order part, at the moment of handover
Cash at the door	The agent completes the delivery	Same, written by the same service

A parent order is marked paid **only when no part is still outstanding**. A second callback for an order already paid or refunded is refused, recorded, and flagged for review — and the database itself carries a unique constraint on the gateway reference, so a replayed callback cannot be counted twice even if the application logic were wrong.

CASH CARRIES LIMITS THE OTHER METHODS DO NOT

Cash on fulfilment is real money a seller may never see, so it is offered conditionally: a seller can refuse it entirely; there is a cap on the order value; a cap on how many unfinished cash orders one customer may hold at once; and a strike count for no-shows the customer caused, which ages out over a window. Each limit is a setting, and the checkout says which one applied rather than silently removing the option.

12 RULES THE SYSTEM ENFORCES

ACCESS CONTROL IS TWO THINGS, AND THE SECOND IS THE ONE THAT COUNTS

The **route gate** answers “should this person see this area at all?” The **query scope** answers “is this row theirs?” and lives in the `WHERE` clause. Rows another person owns are never fetched and then hidden — they are never selected.

A request for somebody else’s reference returns nothing, and the page gives **the same 404 it gives for a reference that never existed**. That identity is deliberate: if “not yours” looked different from “no such thing”, the difference would be a way to discover which references are real.

CODES

- Stored only as a SHA-256 hash. The plain text exists in the message that was sent and nowhere else.
- Readable by nobody — not the seller, not support, not an administrator.
- Reissuing invalidates the old one immediately, tells the customer, and is audited.
- Wrong attempts are counted, and the code locks before it can be guessed.

THE AUDIT TRAIL

- Append-only. Corrections are new rows, never edits.
- A support order lookup records the agent, the record, the time **and the stated reason**; the row is written before the read, so a lookup that fails is still recorded.
- Consent is a history, not a flag: proving what somebody agreed to, and when, needs the whole trail rather than the latest value.
- Stock movements and order status changes are both ledgers for the same reason.

WHAT THE BROWSER IS NEVER TRUSTED WITH

- **Prices and totals** — every amount is computed server-side from database prices at checkout.
- **Stock** — the authoritative check runs under a row lock inside the order transaction; the one on the page is advisory and says so.
- **Identity** — a role in a form field means nothing; the session decides.
- **File paths** — an uploaded file is stored under a generated name, so there is nothing in a path to traverse with.

HOW THIS IS VERIFIED

779 assertions across 14 suites run against the real database and clean up after themselves: three consecutive runs leave every row count, every stock figure and the append-only ledgers exactly where they

started. Four of the suites drive the site the way a browser does — real routes, real middleware, real CSRF check — and then examine the rows that appeared. Nothing in them is stubbed.

SUITE	ASSERTIONS
Core, domain and state machine, schema contracts	113
Auth and access control	73
Catalogue, checkout, fulfilment and payment	197
Retention and messaging; support, admin and CLI	128
Oversell under concurrent connections	7
Customer, seller, delivery and support journeys over HTTP	255
Total	779